

GRIFFIN

 GLOBAL TECHNOLOGIES

RISING STAR

PROFESSIONALISM IN THE WORKPLACE



Introduction: What is Professionalism?

Professionalism is the consistent demonstration of responsibility, respect, integrity, and excellence in how we work, communicate, and deliver results.

It encompasses your demeanor, attitude, and conduct — from your first day until long after you leave.

Punctuality	Communication	Respect	Accountability	Integrity	Virtual Conduct
Be on time, every time	Clear & respectful	For all colleagues	Own your outcomes	Honesty always	Remote = same standard

Punctuality & Reliability

Arrive at your workstation **at least 15 minutes** before your scheduled start time to settle in and resolve any technical issues before work begins.

Join virtual or in-person meetings **5 minutes early** and be fully ready when the meeting starts. Consistent punctuality builds team trust.

Meet all deadlines. If a delay is anticipated, **communicate proactively** with all relevant parties — don't wait until the deadline passes.

Reliability means your team can count on you without needing to follow up. Deliver on your commitments **without reminders**.

Frequent lateness disrupts team flow, signals disrespect for others' time, and erodes your professional credibility.

Scenario: Sarah has a 9 AM client call. She logs on at 8:55 AM, tests her audio, reviews the agenda, and is ready to begin exactly at 9:00 AM.

The client notices she is always prepared. Over time, this builds trust and strengthens the professional relationship.

Effective Communication



Choose the right channel: urgent matters may need a call, detailed updates suit email, quick questions work on Teams chat. Match the medium to the message.



Be clear and concise. Avoid ambiguous language that could be misinterpreted, especially in written communication where tone is harder to convey.



Active listening is a core communication skill — give full attention, do not interrupt, and confirm understanding before responding.



Respond to messages and requests in a timely manner. A delayed response signals either disorganization or disrespect for the sender.



In disagreements, focus on ideas and solutions — not individuals. Keep discussions constructive and professional, even in difficult moments.

Scenario: James receives a complex request via Teams. Instead of responding immediately, he reads carefully, asks one clarifying question, and sends a well-structured reply within the hour.

His response is clear, complete, and professional — reducing back-and-forth and saving everyone's time.

Respect & Etiquette

Use respectful, professional language in all communications — written, verbal, and in meetings — regardless of the recipient's role or seniority.

Allow others to speak fully during discussions. Interrupting signals that you value your own voice over others' contributions.

Be mindful of tone in written messages. Without vocal cues, text can easily appear blunt, dismissive, or aggressive unintentionally.

Show appreciation for colleagues' support and collaboration. A simple 'thank you' reinforces a positive team culture.

Handle disagreements constructively. Differences in opinion are normal and healthy — the approach to resolving them defines professionalism.

Scenario: During a team meeting, Amara disagrees with a proposed approach. Instead of dismissing it, she says: 'I see the value in that idea. Could we also consider...?'

This acknowledges the colleague's input, maintains respect, and moves the conversation forward constructively.

Accountability & Work Quality

Accountability

Own your tasks from start to finish — do not wait for reminders to deliver committed work.

When mistakes happen, acknowledge them promptly and focus on solutions rather than blame.

Follow through on every commitment you make, whether to a colleague, manager, or client.

Delivering promised reports on time — without prompts — is one of the clearest demonstrations of accountability.

Work Quality

Review all work before submission: check for errors, completeness, and that all requirements are met.

Small errors can lead to misunderstandings, project delays, and loss of client trust — attention to detail matters.

Reducing rework through careful review demonstrates ownership and saves the entire team's time.

High-quality output reflects respect for your team and your clients, not just your own reputation.

Confidentiality & Integrity

Protect company and client information at all times — data, financial records, reports, and internal communications are strictly confidential.

Share information only with authorized individuals on a need-to-know basis. Use only approved and secure platforms.

Avoid discussing sensitive matters in public spaces, unsecured networks, or informal settings where information could be overheard or intercepted.

Integrity means being honest, transparent, and ethical in all decisions — accurate reporting of progress, challenges, and results is non-negotiable.

Take prompt accountability for errors; do not hide or minimize mistakes. Transparency builds trust far more effectively than a perfect record.

Scenario: David discovers a pricing error in a client proposal about to be sent. He immediately flags it to his manager, corrects the document, and explains the delay briefly to the client.

His transparency avoids a costly mistake and reinforces the company's reputation for integrity.

VIRTUAL & REMOTE PROFESSIONALISM

Camera on: join virtual meetings with your camera enabled. Being visible signals engagement, respect, and accountability to your team.

Log on at least **5 minutes before** meeting time. Ensure your background is clean, neutral, and free from distractions.

Dress appropriately for virtual meetings — the same **professional standards** that apply in the office apply on screen.

Minimize distractions: reduce background noise, close unrelated tabs, disable notifications, and ensure a stable internet connection.

Be actively present: contribute when required, respond in chat, and avoid multitasking. Passive participation affects team productivity and perception.

Scenario: Naledi joins a client video call from home. She wears a neat blouse, sits against a tidy wall, joins 5 minutes early, and keeps her mic muted when not speaking.

The client sees a professional, engaged consultant — not a remote worker dialing in casually.

Setting Boundaries & Office Interactions



Too Few Boundaries

- ☐ Oversharing personal details
- ☐ Reduced professionalism
- ☐ Loss of trust in sensitive matters



Too Many Boundaries

- ☐ Appearing distant or unapproachable
- ☐ Weak team relationships
- ☐ Limited communication and collaboration



Best Practice

- ☐ Share only work-relevant personal information
- ☐ Build rapport through appropriate interests and preferences
- ☐ Maintain professional respect and credibility

Workplace Communication Etiquette: Take calls away from workstations, use boardrooms or designated discussion areas, keep loud or casual conversations out of shared workspace, and help maintain focus and productivity for everyone.

THANK YOU!

Q&A